In Before the Golden Age, I mention this incident and say, "It must have been a handwritten letter, for in 1935, I didn't know how to type and, for that matter, I had no access to a typewriter."

That wasn't so. That passage was written before I got my copy of The Senior Recorder with its evidence that I was already a typist, and though I introduced changes in galleys to take what it said into account, I somehow missed this passage.

And, of course, there was the typewriter. Once I got the typewriter, I had learned how to type by myself—with my father's help.

Naturally, I knew how to type in the sense that I knew how to put the paper into the machine, and I knew that if you struck the key marked /, and you got an f or, if you also struck the "shift," an F. I knew how to make a space, a back space, how to return the carriage, and so on. What I didn't know was how to touch-type. I didn't think that was necessary. I sat at the typewriter and typed by the hunt-and-peck method.

I was at it every day until my father, coming up one day for his af-

3 I was going to say "unqualified critic," but I hate unnecessary adjectives.

ternoon nap, stopped to watch his son type. He frowned and said, "Why do you type with one finger, instead of with all your fingers like on a piano?"

I said, "I don't know how to do it with all my fingers, Pappa."

My father had an easy solution for that. "Learn!" he thundered. "If I catch you typing with one finger again, I will take away the typewriter."

I sighed, for I knew he would. Fortunately, there was Mazie, who lived across the street and for whom my pure and puppyish passion still continued. She was taking a commercial course in high school and knew how to type.

I asked her how to type and she showed me how to place my hands on the typewriter keys and which fingers controlled which keys. 4 She watched while, very slowly, I typed the word "the" with left-hand-first-finger, right-hand-first finger, and left-hand-middle-finger. She then offered to give me periodic lessons.

An excuse to be alone with her every once in a while was just what I was looking for, but I had my pride. No one was ever allowed to teach me any